25901534 – Answer Key

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026
Fourth SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG4DSCSOC202 - SOCIETY AND
HEALTH: THEORIES, SYSTEMS AND GLOBAL CHALLENGES
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Part A – Short Answer

1. Sociology of Health is important as it studies how social factors influence health, illness, and healthcare systems.
2. The rights of a sick person include access to care, dignity, informed consent, and confidentiality.
3. Health variations among states are influenced by income, education, healthcare access, and public policies.
4. Power shapes medical knowledge by determining whose knowledge is legitimized and applied in healthcare.
5. Sociology of Health examines the relationship between society, health, illness, and medical systems.
6. Health-seeking behaviour is influenced by culture, income, education, accessibility, and beliefs.
7. Medical regulation includes licensing, hospital accreditation, and drug control mechanisms.
8. The government ensures healthcare through policy-making, service delivery, and public health programmes.
9. Professional dominance refers to the control of doctors over healthcare decisions and authority.
10. Health indicators are influenced by nutrition, sanitation, education, income, and access to healthcare.
11. Sociology of Health developed due to epidemiological transitions, medical advancements, and social awareness.
12. Social determinants of health are social and economic conditions that affect health outcomes.
13. National health policy aims to improve accessibility, quality, and equity in healthcare.
14. The epidemiological model explains disease through interaction of agent, host, and environment.
15. Medicalisation refers to defining non-medical issues as medical problems requiring treatment.
16. Public health is important as it focuses on prevention, awareness, and community well-being.

Part B – Short Essay

17a. Definitions of health are shaped by social factors like culture, class, and norms. Different societies interpret health based on their values and lived realities.

17b. Pandemics are large-scale disease outbreaks affecting populations globally. They create health crises with major social, economic, and political consequences.

18a. The conflict perspective views healthcare as shaped by inequality and power relations. It highlights unequal access and dominance of elite groups in health systems.

18b. Kerala's better health indicators result from high literacy, strong public health systems, and social development. Effective policies and community participation also contribute significantly.

19a. Social medicine is important as it integrates social factors into healthcare practices. It emphasizes prevention and community-based health approaches.

19b. Technological development has improved diagnosis, treatment, and access to care. However, it has also increased costs and widened inequalities in healthcare.

20a. From a functionalist perspective, healthcare institutions maintain social stability by treating illness. They help individuals return to their normal social roles.

20b. Medicalization expands medical control over everyday life and behaviour. While it improves treatment, it may also pathologize normal human conditions